31.1.2 Branching middleware pipelines with the Map extension

So far when discussing the middleware pipeline, we've always considered it to be a single pipeline of sequential components. Each request passes through every middleware component until one component generates a response; then the response passes back through the previous middleware.

The `Map` extension method lets you change that simple pipeline into a branching structure. Each branch of the pipeline is independent; a request passes through one branch or the other but not both, as shown in figure 31.1. The `Map` extension method looks at the path of the request's URL. If the path starts with the required pattern, the request travels down the branch of the pipeline; otherwise, it remains on the main trunk. This lets you have completely different behavior in different branches of your middleware pipeline.